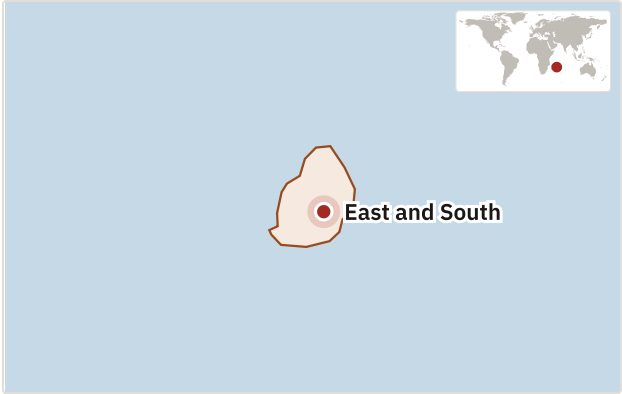
East and South, Mauritius

Water short and storm-prone: here, deaths come weeks after the water event, from mosquito-borne disease. Clear the breeding sites before December.

AREA	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Flacq, Grand Port, and Savanne: 317,091 people (Census 2022); CWA East and South zones about 348,000 (WorldPop 2020 estimate)	None published for Mauritius	Jun 2026 – Feb 2027 (no Mauritius figure)	Mosquito-borne disease; cyclone and flood

18/18 recommendations checked. 12 corrected, 1 unverified, 4 contraindicated (three *Do not* items and one dropped proposal), and 1 dropped as redundant. None was confirmed without correction. 1 funding placement is unverified (the Red Cross kits, at an assumed price). Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk*, September 2026, pre-peer-review. It publishes no figure for Mauritius, and none is scaled here: heat is not this area's documented killer. **The funding target fell from the lens's MUR 63.2m to MUR 6.95m**: a government tank voucher replaced the tank placement, trigger cash moved to one national line outside this envelope, and vector control is priced at Rs 600 a household, piloted until the Ministry of Health confirms it can spend more.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



20.33°S 57.62°E, Mauritius · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** Deaths here come weeks after a storm or water shortage, from mosquito-borne disease, in any ENSO phase.
- **First action.** Health vector-control teams and district councils clear breeding sites by 30 November.
- **The money.** US$62k floor, US$144k target, US$239k ceiling; vector control first. Trigger cash is on the national line.
- **Do not.** No "El Niño drought" messaging: floods and mosquitoes kill here.

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Do not do this	**5** items	p. 12
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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

THE PREMISE READ FIRST

This is not an "El Niño drought" briefing. Across 20 Mauritian rain stations, Pacific and Indian Ocean indices explain an average adjusted R^2 of 0.036 of monthly rainfall [1]. The record 1998–99 drought fell in a La Niña year, and the 2023–24 El Niño summer was wet, at 140% of normal rain [2]. What this season brings is a water deficit carried over from a 2025–26 summer with 66% of normal rain, the MMS bulletin of 10 August 2026 (October–December rain about 92% of normal, near-normal to slightly dry, and warmer than normal), mosquito-borne disease already circulating, and the cyclone season [3][4]. The East and South are wetter and were rationed last. They are also the most cyclone- and flood-exposed part of the island and the cane belt, and they have waited since the 2012 master plan for the Rivière des Anguilles dam. Works on that dam start in late 2026 at the earliest [5].

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet.

1. Clear mosquito breeding sites village by village before December, tyres and discarded containers first, and cover stored water

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · PUBLIC HEALTH · FRONTLINE · EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN · PHILANTHROPIST · SKEPTIC · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
MoH Vector Biology and Control Division, with Flacq, Grand Port, and Savanne District Councils	30 Nov 2026	MUR 0.6m pilot; up to MUR 9.09m (US$188,957) after the MoH check; unit cost assumed	Dengue and chikungunya infections in the outbreak season

Door-to-door, community-mobilised source reduction: remove tyres and small containers, lid or mesh the drums households keep because of rationing, and recruit senior citizens' and women's associations to walk their own streets. In the Camino Verde cluster trial (Nicaragua and Mexico, 18,838 households), it cut dengue infection in children by 29.5% (95% CI 3.8–55.3) and pupae per person by 52% [6]. In Mauritian larval surveys, tyres were the main habitat (9.3% positive at the seaport, against 0.9% for drums, pails, and buckets) [7]. Chikungunya, carried by the same mosquito, is the 2026 epidemic: 6,891 confirmed cases by 28 August 2026, mostly mid-April to

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

early May; the 12 July count of 6,675 included 92 on Rodrigues [8]. The money buys a covers kit (lid or cover, mesh, and larvicide where safe) at Rs 600 a household. That price is an assumption, with no Mauritian quote, so money is released only against a written supplier quote. Councils clear the breeding sites within their existing budgets.

Transferability is weak and the claim is modest. The trial vector was *Ae. aegypti* in low-income urban settings; Mauritius's main vector is *Ae. albopictus*, and the outcome measured was infection, not death. The authors judged the Nicaraguan arm not cost-effective [9]. The 1949–51 elimination of *Ae. aegypti* in Mauritius came from DDT sprayed for malaria, not from source reduction, so it is not a precedent for this [10]. The local container data come from port and airport sites, not households. Six lenses converged here partly because they reach for the same canonical trial. The case for ranking it first rests on the local record (see the record, below), not on that trial.

2. Triage fever in older and diabetic patients for dengue warning signs, and set the outbreak trigger on weekly all-cause deaths

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Ministry of Health and Wellness; Jawaharlal Nehru Hospital (Rose Belle), Flacq Hospital, and area health centres	**Protocol issued by 30 Nov 2026**	**Staff time; no new budget**	**Deaths in the people dengue and leptospirosis kill**

Fast-track febrile patients aged 60+ or with diabetes or heart disease for watching through dengue's critical phase and careful fluids. Treat fever after a flood or cyclone as possible leptospirosis under standard care. With the Civil Status Division, publish weekly all-cause deaths for the three districts, and trigger the outbreak response on them. In a 2024 meta-analysis of 27 studies, diabetes raised the odds of severe dengue (OR 3.39) and death (OR 1.95) [11]. Leptospirosis killed 6 of the 21 people it infected in Mauritius in early 2026, all with other illnesses [12]. In 2006 chikungunya coincided with 743 all-cause excess deaths, a crude-rate comparison with no cause of death established [13].*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Good transferability for the dengue risk factor, given Mauritius's diabetes burden. The 2012 Cochrane review found no proof that antibiotics reduce leptospirosis deaths (OR 1.16, 0.23–5.95), so this is standard care, not a mortality claim [14]. No district breakdown of 2026 disease cases is published for the East or South.

3. Run one tabletop exercise that combines the cyclone and water-crisis schemes, and audit every refuge centre

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
NDRRMC, supervising the Flacq, Grand Port, and Savanne Local DRRM Committees	30 Nov 2026	Staff time	Evacuees arriving at dry, flooded, or mosquito-breeding shelters

The National Disaster Scheme treats cyclone and water crisis in separate chapters. This season they arrive together: a cyclone cuts power to pumps in a zone already short of water, evacuees crowd shelters with no water, and the water left stored at home breeds mosquitoes. The DRRM Act 2016 already requires Local Committees to run drills under NDRRMC supervision (s.20(e)) [15]. Audit each refuge centre for flood-zone siting, stored drinking water, keyholders, and covered storage. Quatre Soeurs (opened 2023) has rainwater harvesting for about 1,000 people [16].

The legal basis is solid; the evidence that exercises save lives is process-level only. The National Disaster Scheme (2015) is "under revision" and its shelter annex is stale, so the audit doubles as the update [17]. No 2026 exercise was found.

4. Clear the existing drains at known hotspots, assign barricades to low crossings, and adopt local rain triggers

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · ECONOMIST · SKEPTIC · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
District councils (Local Committees), with the Land Drainage Authority and Police / SMF	30 Nov 2026	Existing budgets brought forward	Drownings at flooded crossings, as in Belal

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The LDA's Rs 993m drain list is pending in the 2026–27 budget and cannot be built before the peak [18]. Clearing what exists can. The Land Drainage Master Plan names the high-risk zones [19]. During Cyclone Belal (January 2024, an El Niño summer) the warning lagged the rain, a motorcyclist died on a flooded highway, and the met-service director resigned [20]. Local Committees should agree rainfall or river-level thresholds that open shelters and close roads without waiting for a warning-class change.

No evidence was found on whether local triggers reduce deaths. Claims about specific April 2021 and 2022 floods in the South were not confirmed by name in the sources found.

5. Find isolated older people outside the senior citizens' associations, and check on them through the season

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FRONTLINE · PUBLIC HEALTH · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Senior Citizens Council and its village associations	Lists by 1 Dec 2026; weekly to Mar 2027	Volunteer time	People found too late, alone at home

Each association names its non-member neighbours who live alone. Volunteers call or visit weekly from December and on every cyclone-warning or heavy-rain day. The list of people who must be carried to a refuge centre goes to the village council before the first warning. There are 900+ associations [21], and about 18% of Mauritians are 60 or older [22]. In 2026 a leptospirosis patient in Camp-de-Masque (Flacq district) was found in serious condition after days alone at home [12]. In Chicago in 1995, living alone (OR 2.3) and not leaving home daily (OR 6.7) were the strongest predictors of heat death, and social contact was protective [23].

The evidence links isolation to death; no trial shows that check-ins prevent deaths. Chicago is a heat wave in a US city, not a Mauritian cyclone season.

6. Audit standby power at the East and South boreholes and treatment plants, then fill the gaps

UNVERIFIED · UNFUNDED · EMERGENCY MANAGER · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Central Water Authority, with the CEB	Audit by 15 Nov; generators by 15 Dec 2026	Not costed; unfunded	A cyclone power cut collapsing supply in a rationed zone

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The East and South have 65 boreholes (East 29, South 36) [24]. During Belal, power cuts "had an immediate impact on water production at treatment plants," and 10,000 families were still without power days later [25]. Dina (2002) cut power to about 90% of the main island [26]. List which boreholes and plants lack standby generators, and rent or connect generators for those before the cyclone season.*

Unverified because the premise could not be checked: whether the CWA already has standby power at these sites, and what share of East and South supply comes from boreholes. The CWA site did not load. Generator fuel competes with a utility already under drought cost pressure.

7. Register uncarded lagoon fishers before the cyclone season so the bad-weather allowance reaches them

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · FRONTLINE · FOOD · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Ministry of Blue Economy and Fisheries	1 Dec 2026	Rs 800 per fisher per declared bad-weather day	Fishers going to sea in warnings because they cannot afford not to

The Bad Weather Allowance is the only trigger-paid instrument here. It pays Rs 800 per declared bad-weather day to about 2,506 active registered fishers, roughly Rs 40m a month, paid monthly after a check-in at the fishing post between the 9th and 15th [27]. Uncarded fishers get nothing. Southeast fishers in Vieux Grand Port, Ville Noire, and Cité La Chaux found their applications missing from the system after Wakashio [28]. Hold registration clinics at the Mahébourg and Trou d'Eau Douce posts on check-in days.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrected: the rate is Rs 800 (Rs 650 was the 2023–24 rate), and the payment lag is 2–6 weeks, not months. So registration matters more than paying faster. Village counts of uncarded fishers were not found. Dina (2002) is reported to have killed five fishermen at sea off Rodrigues, on secondary sourcing only [26].

8. Enrol every East and South household without storage in the new Rs 15,000 tank voucher, and ask for a sealed lid on every tank

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Ministry of Energy and Public Utilities, with the DBM, CWA, and district councils	Enrolment drive by 30 Nov 2026	Funded by government; volunteer time	Open drums as the household's rationing buffer

On 9 October 2026 Cabinet extended the Water Tank and Pump Grant to every household without a tank, tenants included, with no income test. The DBM issues a Rs 15,000 voucher [29]. That replaces the older Rs 8,000 grant and the MUR 175m budget line [30][31]. So the action is enrolment, not money: councils and volunteers help elderly and Kreol-only households file, and record who is excluded, such as squatters and tenants without landlord consent. The Ministry of Health should ask the DBM that every grant tank come with a sealed lid and screened vent.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Accounts differ on what the voucher buys, and no lid rule has been published. Thousands of new containers will reach back yards just before mosquito season. This action is the reason the Skeptic's warning about open storage is a *Do not* item rather than a contradiction: the tank helps only if it is sealed.

9. Prepare a DREF request for a Class II cyclone warning, pre-position kits, and start drafting a cyclone Early Action Protocol

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Mauritius Red Cross Society, with the IFRC	Request drafted by 30 Nov 2026	Kits MUR 2.4m (US$50k, unit price assumed)	Relief that waits for a photograph

Mauritius holds no pre-arranged risk finance. It has not signed the ARC treaty, the World Bank Cat DDO was never approved (the follow-on development policy financing was dropped in May 2025), and the Mauritius Red Cross has no Early Action Protocol [32][33]. IFRC's 2026 plan for Mauritius and Seychelles is CHF 184,000 [34]. A DREF request can be filed before impact, but without an EAP release is discretionary. Draft it now, keyed to an MMS Class II warning for the East and South: government already used Class II to open the Belal power-cut relief window [35]. Start an EAP for next season. Madagascar's cyclone EAP holds CHF 546,835 for readiness and CHF 345,952 for early action [36].

An EAP cannot be approved before this peak. The US$50 kit price is an assumption; no IFRC kit price was verified.

10. Pre-agree a cash top-up for food-insecure households in the South, released on a Class II or heavy-rain warning

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PHILANTHROPIST · ECONOMIST · FOOD | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
National Solidarity Fund and National Empowerment Foundation	Agreed by 30 Nov 2026; paid on trigger	Draws on the national cash line MU-F01; not counted here	Harm, not deaths: hunger and debt after a storm

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

FoodWise counts about 22,000 food-insecure people in the South, from Mahébourg to La Gaulette (260,000 inhabitants) [37]. Cash for the whole island now runs as one national line, MU-F01: Rs 5,000 a Social Register household, capped at Rs 2.8M per trigger and shared by all six zones, paid by the NEF and NSF. The cap is the largest comparable payout on record: Rs 2.795M to Rodrigues after the rains of 15 March 2026, announced on 4 April, about three weeks later (Rs 795k from the NEF and Rs 2M from the NSF) [38]. This zone's job is the priority list: food-insecure households in the South, ready before the season, for the NEF to draw on when the trigger fires. Cash beats in-kind here: markets function, maximum retail prices hold on staples, and the payment rail works. The national trigger is an MMS Class II cyclone warning or an MMS heavy-rain warning. A price trigger for the South (food inflation above 8% year on year) was considered and not adopted for this season: no payment in Mauritius has ever been made on a price index, and the season starts within weeks, so the rule stays weather-only. Watch the monthly CPI instead: in September 2026 food inflation was 6.2%, up from 3.9% in August, and headline inflation 5.7%, up from 4.9% [39].

The lens proposed 4,510 households (MUR 22.6m), about eight times the largest payout on record, and that capacity is unproven. The national cap allows about 560 households per trigger, island-wide, and the NEF decides the split at the trigger; nothing is pre-allocated to the South. The rule is weather-only this season. No food-insecurity figure covers Flacq.

11. Hold potato, onion, and garlic stock near Flacq and Mahébourg, and promote the price hotline

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | UNFUNDED | FOOD | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Agricultural Marketing Board, with the Ministry of Commerce	15 Dec 2026	Not costed (cold-room rental); unfunded	A one-to-two-week price spike when roads flood

Mauritius ate 29,000 t of potatoes in 2024 and grew 13,000 t, and the promised Rs 300m cold store has not been built [40]. The AMB already licenses these imports and holds statutory storage and market-stabilisation powers [41]. Heavy rain cut eastern tomato and carrot output by almost half in January 2018 [42]. Promote Hotline 185 and WhatsApp 5942 8888 for breaches of maximum retail prices in Centre de Flacq, Mahébourg, and Rose Belle [43].

No AMB regional stores or buffer-stock scheme were found, so this asks the board to use powers it already has. The El Niño food signal here is weak: import prices and rain timing drive local prices more.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	MoH	Councils	NDRRMC	LDA	Police / SMF	SCC	CWA / CEB	Fisheries	MEPU / DBM	MRCS	NSF / NEF	AMB / Commerce
1. Breeding-site clearance	**A/R**	**R**	**I**			**C**						
2. Fever triage and death trigger	**A/R**		**I**									
3. Tabletop and refuge audit	**C**	**R**	**A**		**C**		**C**			**C**		
4. Drains, crossings, local triggers		**A/R**	**C**	**R**	**R**							
5. Isolated older people	**I**	**C**				**A/R**				**C**		
6. Standby power audit			**I**				**A/R**					
7. Register lagoon fishers			**I**					**A/R**				
8. Lidded water-tank grant	**C**	**R**					**R**		**A/R**			
9. DREF request, kits, EAP			**C**							**A/R**		
10. Trigger-released cash		**C**									**A/R**	
11. Food stock and hotline		**I**										**A/R**

What the chart shows: the district councils carry the most rows (seven), and the Ministry of Health is accountable for the two highest-ranked actions. Seven of the eleven rows need a decision or staff time rather than new money. Only actions 1 and 9 need outside funding in this envelope; action 10 draws on the national cash line. MoH: Ministry of Health and Wellness. SCC: Senior Citizens Council. MEPU: Ministry of Energy and Public Utilities. MRCS: Mauritius Red Cross Society.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs. Rate: US$1 = MUR 48.1061 (MRA customs rate, week of 12–18 Oct 2026) [44].

FLOOR

MUR 3.01m (US$62k)

TARGET

MUR 6.95m (US$144k)

CEILING

MUR 11.50m (US$239k)

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

Whether the Ministry of Health can spend a covers-kit scale-up before December (written check due 15 November)

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Floor = a 1,000-household covers-kit pilot at Rs 600 (MUR 0.6m, US$12,472) + 1,000 Red Cross kits at an assumed US$50 (US$50,000, MUR 2.41m) = MUR 3.01m = US$62,472. The floor is largely assumption-based: both unit prices are assumed, not quoted. **Target** = covers kits for half the high-risk households, 7,575 at Rs 600 (MUR 4.55m, US$94,479) + Red Cross kits = MUR 6.95m = US$144,479. **Ceiling** = covers kits for all of them, about 15,150 households (MUR 9.09m, US$188,957) + Red Cross kits = MUR 11.50m = US$238,957. The household count is this briefing's 50,000 high-risk residents divided by 3.3 people per household. That size is an assumption: no official Census 2022 average was verified, though the census totals (1,235,260 people in about 369,000 private households) give about 3.3. Scale beyond the pilot is released only after the Ministry of Health confirms in writing, by 15 November, that it can spend it; one check covers its three placements in the North, Port Louis, and here. The councils' breeding-site clearance runs on existing budgets. Trigger cash is not in this envelope. It draws on the national line MU-F01, which is counted once for the whole set. The need there is far larger than any cap: FoodWise's count implies about 4,510 food-insecure households in Grand Port and Savanne (22,000 × 178,562 ÷ 260,000, at 3.35 per household), against about 560 households per trigger island-wide. The 13 October envelope (MUR 11.39m / 22.88m / 47.63m) priced vector control at the Camino Verde cost per person and was about six times the other zones' targets; this revision replaces it. Every amount is our arithmetic from stated unit costs, not a quoted budget.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
MoH Vector Biology and Control Division, with Flacq, Grand Port, and Savanne District Councils	Action 1: covers kits (lid or cover, mesh, larvicide where safe) for high-risk households, plus council breeding-site clearance	MUR 0.6m pilot (US$12,472) at the floor; MUR 4.55m at target; MUR 9.09m (US$188,957) at the ceiling	Direct-grant top-up, released in stages	Rs 600 a household, an assumption with no Mauritian quote; money released only against a written supplier quote. Floor funds a 1,000-household pilot only; target and ceiling are released after the Ministry of Health confirms in writing, by 15 November, that it can spend them (one check across the North, Port Louis, and East and South placements). About 15,150 high-risk households = 50,000 residents ÷ 3.3 (assumed household size). Context: Camino Verde cut infection, but its Nicaraguan arm was judged not cost-effective [6][9]	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Mauritius Red Cross Society	Action 9: 1,000 pre-positioned cyclone and flood kits	MUR 2.41m (US$50,000)	Pre-positioned stock	Kit price assumed; no IFRC price verified	UNVERIFIED
National Empowerment Foundation and National Solidarity Fund	Action 10: trigger-released cash for the South's priority list	Draws on the national trigger-cash line MU-F01 (Rs 5,000 a household, Rs 2.8M cap per trigger, shared by all six zones): **not counted in this envelope** [38]			

The funder's one thing: the Mauritian state will outspend any donor here, and its water budget is capital that lands after the peak. Outside money should buy speed and reach, meaning the fishers and households the state's lists miss. It should not go to tanks: the Rs 15,000 voucher already pays for them, and a lid rule on that voucher is worth more than any placement here. Caritas Île Maurice was proposed as a recipient for households off the Social Register, but no evidence of spending at this scale was found, so it is not funded here.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives here.

Do not brief this season as an "El Niño drought"

CONTRAINDICATED

The station study finds El Niño explains almost none of Mauritius's rainfall (mean adjusted R^2 0.036) [1]. The record drought of 1998–99 fell in La Niña (ONI −1.51), and the El Niño summer of 2023–24 brought 140% of normal rain and the largest dengue outbreak on record [2]. A drought message that is easy to fund points people at the hazard with the weakest local signal. It readies them for dry heat, and here the deaths come from floods and mosquitoes.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: say "water short and storm-prone". Ration and prepare for floods at the same time, and keep people out of underpasses and low crossings.

Do not lead mosquito control with fogging

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

Space spraying has no residual effect, and a systematic review found "no clear evidence" for it as a stand-alone intervention [45]. *Ae. albopictus* in neighbouring Réunion shows pyrethroid resistance (preprint, 2025) [46], and Mauritius's own resistance monitoring is "pending" [7]. Visible fogging reassures without reducing breeding. That is the 2026 criticism of the reactive response in Mauritius [47].

Instead: lead with source reduction (action 1). Fog only around confirmed cases, after resistance has been tested.

Do not tell households to "store more water" in open containers

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

In Brisbane, removing rainwater tanks helped eliminate *Ae. aegypti*, and the 300,000+ tanks installed in the 2000s drought raised the risk that it would come back [48]. In Mauritius, drums and buckets are a minor habitat next to tyres [7]. But the larval data come from ports, not homes during rationing. An open drum kept for weeks is the habitat no survey has measured, and rationing produces exactly that.

Instead: publish a fixed rationing timetable so households do not hoard, and press for a sealed lid on every tank the new voucher buys (action 8).

Do not count the Rivière des Anguilles dam, new boreholes, or desalination as this summer's buffer

CONTRAINDICATED

The dam was recommended in 2009 and put in the 2012 master plan. Its tender closed on 8 April 2026, works start in November or December 2026 at the earliest, and delivery is due in November 2029 [5]. The MUR 6.4bn water allocation is three-year capital spending [49]. None of it holds water before March 2027.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: plan around the storage that exists, protect pumping from power cuts (action 6), and fix leaks. In 2025 the CWA lost 60% of the water it produced as non-revenue water (200.5 of 332.6 million m³), with no improvement on 2024 [56].

Do not issue heat or cooling advice that assumes mains power after a cyclone

CONTRAINDICATED

Belal left about 8,400 people without power [20]. Hollanda (1994) cut power to about half the island, and Dina (2002) to about 90% of the main island [26][50]. Fans, refrigerated medicines, and electric pumps fail at the moment they are needed.

Instead: name shaded refuges with water, use battery radio for warnings, and plan cold storage for insulin at health centres.*

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1866–68	Malaria epidemic across the island, peak 1867	About 40,000 deaths, roughly a tenth of the island's population (1867) [51]	Bois Marchand cemetery opened for the dead; malaria eliminated only in 1969
Feb 1960	Cyclone Carol (ENSO neutral)	42 dead; 70,000–100,000 houses destroyed or damaged [52]	Reported to have prompted cyclone-proof housing estates; not checked here
6 Feb 1975	Cyclone Gervaise (weak La Niña)	10 dead; about 25% of cane lost [53]	*P. vivax* malaria re-established after it; eliminated again only in 1998
10 Feb 1994	Cyclone Hollanda (neutral)	2 dead; 1,500+ homeless; half the island without power; nearly half the sugar crop lost [50]	Nothing found

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1998–99	Record drought (La Niña, ONI −1.51)	Sugar about 340,000 t against 625,000 t potential (official 373,294 t) [54]	Midlands dam completed 2002
Jan 2002	Cyclone Dina (neutral)	4 dead on Mauritius; 5 fishermen reported lost off Rodrigues (secondary source); ~90% of the main island without power [26]	Nothing found
Feb–May 2006	Chikungunya (weak La Niña)	12,260 cases Feb–Apr; 743 all-cause excess deaths Mar–May, cause not established [13]	Vector-control programme rebuilt
Dec 2023 – Apr 2024	Dengue, the largest outbreak on record (El Niño, ONI +1.84)	3,311 cases on the main island and 1,363 on Rodrigues, with 4 deaths, to 19 Mar 2024 (WHO AFRO); then about 7,177 cases and 15 deaths nationally by 28 Apr (TravelHealthPro, secondary) [55]. The government's own figure is 6,673 cases and 8 deaths (June 2024)	Nothing found
15 Jan 2024	Cyclone Belal (El Niño)	1 dead, a motorcyclist on a flooded highway; ~8,400 people without power [20]	The met-service director resigned; Rs 2,000 per household for long power cuts [35]
Jan–Jul 2026	Chikungunya and leptospirosis	6,891 confirmed chikungunya cases by 28 August, mostly mid-April to early May (the 12 July count of 6,675 included 92 on Rodrigues) [8]; 21 leptospirosis cases, 6 deaths [12]	Ongoing

The recurrence nobody has noticed: water, then mosquitoes, then deaths. Malaria in 1867, *vivax* after Gervaise in 1975, chikungunya in 2006, and dengue in 2024 each followed a water event, and their deaths came weeks after the wind. Two of those four followed La Niña seasons (1975 and 2006), one followed an El Niño (2024), and the ENSO phase of 1867 is unknown, so the ENSO label does not predict who dies here. A dry 2026–27 with rationing can produce the same stored water without any cyclone at all. No district-level toll for Grand Port, Flacq, or Savanne was found for any event; these are national figures.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **Cover the stored water** (Frontline, Emergency manager, Philanthropist) versus **tyres first; storage drums are a minor habitat here** (Skeptic). Mauritian surveys found drums 0.9% positive and tyres 9.3%, but at the seaport, not in homes under rationing. A household larval survey in one rationed East or South village would settle it. Until then, action 1 does tyres first and lids as well.
- **Pay the fishers' allowance within 7 days of a warning** (Economist) versus **register the fishers the allowance misses** (Frontline, verification). The payment lag turned out to be 2–6 weeks, while uncarded fishers get nothing at all, so registration ranks higher.
- **A district-level trigger for the Sugar Insurance Fund** (Economist) was **dropped as contraindicated as framed**. The SIF Act already declares event years by factory area (s.25) and compensates small planters by region (s.31). The real lever, redrawing those regions, is a board decision for a later season.
- **The STC forward-buying rice and flour** (Food) was **dropped as redundant**. Flour is contracted to September 2027, rice is bought by routine quarterly tender, and India's rice stocks are at a record.
- **Heat check-ins modelled on Ahmedabad** (Public health) versus **no evidence that heat kills here**. No Mauritian heat-mortality study exists. The check-ins survive in action 5 for isolation, not heat.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

No lens found disease data below the national level. Dengue, chikungunya, and leptospirosis cases are not published for the East or South, so no action here could be targeted by village, and the ranking rests on the national record. The second gap is the sea. No lens examined marine heatwaves, coral bleaching in the Mahébourg and Blue Bay lagoons, or the east-coast hotel workforce. A hot El Niño summer can cut lagoon fish and tourism income at the same time as it cuts water, and that would hit the same households action 7 and action 10 are trying to reach.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

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Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale. This area sits in region MUS.R8e39d7d595d97ac3 (label unconfirmed): the main island outside Port Louis and Plaines Wilhems, plus Rodrigues, about 850,000 people. They are not neighbourhood figures, and the study publishes none for Mauritius. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; drought, flood, fire, smoke, and crop failure are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED

METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The location was the East and South water supply zones of the Central Water Authority: the districts of Flacq, Grand Port, and Savanne. This is briefing 6 of six in the Mauritius set, which is aligned to the CWA's supply zones rather than to district lines. Climate Impact Lab impact region: MUS.R8e39d7d595d97ac3 (label unconfirmed), decoded from the Impact Map boundary file. It covers the main island outside Port Louis and Plaines Wilhems, plus Rodrigues, about 850,000 people. The study publishes no Mauritius figure. Population figures: Census 2022 (Statistics Mauritius) for the three districts (Flacq 138,529, Grand Port 110,783, Savanne 67,779; total 317,091, as tabulated by citypopulation.de [57]); WorldPop 2020 estimate (about 348,000) for the two CWA supply zones, which the census does not publish. Sub-city detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Where heat is not the dominant hazard, the historical record carries the hazard instead of a borrowed number.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief. National facts came from a verified evidence pack (two Storm research briefings, 13 October 2026, 87 citations checked), which the lenses reused and did not re-research.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Six verifier agents checked every recommendation on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). Financial actions were also checked for availability in this jurisdiction, a named payer, a trigger threshold, and whether they already exist.

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Food actions were checked for whether their price triggers are actually published. The funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed. The do-not items and the historical record had their own verifier.

- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not re-queried in this run, where a fetch returned no entries. The Upper and Lower Mare aux Vacoas briefings, built the same day, read the dataset embedded in the inventory page: 96 entries, none for Mauritius and none on vector control, water rationing, or flash-flood warning. The tags say "no Mauritius entry", which means no matching precedent was found, not that the action is unprecedented.
- **Map data.** Actions, funding, and events are also written as map data beside this file. Actions that serve both supply zones use `CWA-EASTSOUTH`, the agreed union of `CWA-EAST` and `CWA-SOUTH`; the trigger-released cash serves `CWA-SOUTH`; national items use `MU`. Items repeated across the six briefings (the "El Niño drought", fogging, and open-storage *Do not* cards, the tank-lid ask, and the trigger-cash rule) carry a `national_ref` to one shared national feature, and the cash action points to the national placement MU-F01. No action has a point location.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (dengue warning signs and fluids, fever after floods, standby power for water supply, shade and drinking water in the heat, and insulin storage) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. Much of the 2026 data reaches us through Mauritian press (L'Express via AllAfrica) because ministry and CWA pages could not be reached directly. The CWA website did not load, and the Statistics Mauritius CPI release was read through a secondary source. No district-level disease or casualty data was found. The impact region's code is decoded, but its displayed label is unconfirmed.

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- **Revision.** Revised 2026-10-14 after the set audit (fixes applied: 1 impact region; 2 trigger cash moved to the national line MU-F01; 3 vector control rebuilt on covers kits at Rs 600 a household with a 1,000-household pilot pending the MoH check; 4 national references in the map data; 5 exchange rate checked at MUR 48.1061; 6 dengue two-stage wording; 7 chikungunya 6,891; 9 MMS bulletin wording; 10 Rodrigues relief dates, Cat DDO, 1867 toll, and population basis; 11 inflation figures; 12 ENSO count; 13 RACI row 8; 14 area codes; 15 unfunded tags and citations). Fix 8 (rationing dates) did not touch this briefing.

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

the census)

Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

Generated 13 October 2026, revised 14 October 2026, for East and South, Mauritius. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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